days later, on 4 February, there was a peaceful march against police brutality at the local marketplace. This is when police reaction got even worse—they fired on the gathered crowd. An enraged mob now set the police station on fire and burned twenty-three policemen alive in the process.

What did Mahatma Gandhi do? His immediate concern was to appease the rulers of the Raj. So, a week later, on 12 February 1922, he called off the entire non-cooperation movement. This was just as it was beginning to become effective. He took the decision without consulting anyone. This left many stunned. Others in the non-cooperation movement, such as Jawaharlal Nehru, Sardar Patel and Rajendra Prasad felt positively aggrieved and let down. Gandhi's betrayal left them in a political vacuum. A party founded in 1885 as an organization representing Indian elites and comprising upper castes and classes was not unknown to benefit from colonial rule, while still protesting against the iniquities of the British Raj. Even for them this betrayal was a bit much. The non-violent resistance movement became discredited. Into the vacuum created by Gandhi poured in the angst of a new revolutionary politics. At its helm stood none other than Bhagat Singh.

The publication of this book is timely for this reason. It coincides with the hundred-year anniversary of the 1922 schism in Indian politics. This is when many split from Gandhi and when Bhagat Singh actively began advocating the overthrow of colonial rule by revolution. It is the decisive moment when he totally distanced himself from Mahatma Gandhi's creed of non-violence. Bhagat Singh's pursuit of India's freedom would take a different course.

In fact, compared to the actions of Mahatma Gandhi over the 1922 Chauri Chaura incident, Bhagat Singh's throwing of two bombs into the Central Legislative Assembly on 8 April 1929 with B.K. Dutt 'to make the deaf hear' was a highly sophisticated and strategic act. It came in the form of a spectacular demonstration of the rejection of continued British occupation in India, but it did so without causing any lasting personal damage to anyone. In the ensuing trial, Bhagat Singh would have escaped with a long prison sentence, but unfortunately for him, it was the police